

35 MILLION PESOS

THE AMOUNT OF MONEY SPAIN RECEIVED ANNUALLY FROM ITS COLONIES AT THE TIME OF CHARLES III'S DEATH



A portrait of Charles IV (center right) and his family by Spanish painter Francisco Goya (1746–1828).

AFTER ALMOST 30 YEARS ON THE SPANISH THRONE, the “enlightened despot” Charles III died, and his son, **Charles IV** (1748–1819), inherited the crown. Unlike his father, Charles IV was not a strong leader. His wife, **Maria Luisa** of Parma (1751–1819), and her political protégé **Manuel de Godoy** (1767–1851), who eventually became prime minister, ran the country and the empire, leading it into disaster. This period was marked by **constant warfare with France**, culminating in an occupation in 1808, when Charles was forced to abdicate (see 1808).

In France, as in Britain, there was growing public support for the **abolition** of slavery. The Committee for the Abolition of the Slave Trade had been established in Britain in May 1787 with the aim of ending the slave trade. Shortly afterward, in February 1788, a group of Parisian men met to set

Arrival in Port Jackson

Colonists arrive in the bay that would later become Sydney, Australia. Native women are shown watching them on the shore.

up the **Société des Amis des Noirs** (Society of the Friends of the Blacks), which called not only for the abolition of the slave trade and slavery, but also urged equality for people of mixed race, the treatment of whom was a growing issue in the French Caribbean sugar colonies.

Meanwhile, in Sweden, **Gustav III** was trying to realize his imperial ambitions by declaring war against Russia without the approval of parliament. He hoped to capture **Finnish** territory while the **Russians** were occupied with their **war against Turkey**. Gustav's efforts failed initially due to a conspiracy by aristocrats and officers angry at the expansion of the Crown's power at the expense of the **Riksdag** (parliament) and the nobility. Officers attempted to negotiate with Catherine the Great of Russia without Gustav's prior knowledge. **Denmark** later joined the **Russo-Swedish War** (to 1790) as an ally of Russia, and laid siege to the key port of Gothenburg, in the southwest of Sweden.

In the neighboring Habsburg Empire, the **Magyar** (Hungarian) nobles were unhappy about Joseph II's reforms (see 1765), in particular the introduction of German as the official language of government and secondary education. Joseph was also planning to restructure the land



tax system, and had already abolished serfdom. By the time of his death in 1790, the Magyars were on the brink of a rebellion, and even appealed to Prussia to support them. However, their discontent did not escalate to armed conflict due to the intervention of Leopold II (1747–92), who succeeded his brother and promised to rescind the previous reforms. He swore to treat Hungary as an independent kingdom and allow for it to be administered under its own laws.

In Britain, Royal Navy Captain Arthur Phillip (1738–1814) had set sail on May 13, 1787 with 11 ships full of convicts destined for settlement at **Botany Bay** in Australia. Captain James Cook (see 1768) had first come across the bay in 1770, and the British government was eager to settle the territory. At the same time, the shipping of convicts to Australia presented a way of relieving Britain's overcrowded prisons. Known as the **First Fleet**, these ships carried more

than 1,400 people, with convicts making up 778 passengers. The fleet arrived in Botany Bay in 1788, but Phillip soon decided the site was not suitable for permanent settlement and the colony moved farther inland to Port Jackson, which would later become known as **Sydney**. Although the early days of settlement were difficult, a stream of ships continued to bring felons, and less than 50 years later there were nearly 60,000 settlers in Australia.



First Fleet

Despite its reputation, only about half of those on the First Fleet were convicts. The remainder included marines, crew, and their families.

January 18
Captain Arthur Phillip's ship, HMS Sirius, arrives at Botany Bay, Australia.

January 26 First Fleet sails from Botany Bay and lands in what will become Sydney, Australia.

February 9 Austria enters Russo-Turkish War (1787–1792)

Governor-General of India, Warren Hastings' trial starts over allegations of crimes committed in India

Sweden at war with Russia and Denmark (to 1790) triggered by Sweden's invasion of Russian Finland

July 26
Governor-General Lord Dorchester divides **Canada** into five districts

Magyar revolt (to 1790) against Josef II in Holy Roman Empire

French abolitionists set up the **Société des amis des Noirs**

December 14 Charles IV (1748–1819) takes Spanish throne